STEPIN E-Sports

Tournament Rulebook



STEPIN

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Chapter 1 — General Provisions

Article 1. Purpose

This Rulebook has been established for the purpose of ensuring fair and efficient administration of the STEPIN E-Sports tournament (hereinafter referred to as the "Tournament"), organized by ECA (Esports Championships Asia).

Article 2. Scope of Application

These regulations shall apply to all participants involved in the Tournament, including competing players, coaches, committee members, referees, and all other relevant personnel.

Chapter 2 — General Matters

Article 3. Common Regulations and Rule Amendments

3.1. Amendment of Match or Set Schedules

In the event that a match or set schedule must be changed due to unavoidable circumstances, the ECA Operations Division (hereinafter the "Operations Division") shall promptly notify all players and relevant parties of such change without delay. Except in cases of force majeure, schedule changes shall not be made in a manner that disadvantages any specific player.

3.2. Amendment of Regulations

The Operations Division reserves the right to amend tournament regulations during the course of the Tournament as necessary. Upon finalizing any amendment, the Operations Division shall immediately notify all players and relevant parties of the updated regulations. Except in cases of unavoidable circumstances, amended regulations shall not be applied in a manner that disadvantages any specific player.

3.3. Determination of Matters Not Covered by Regulations

In the event that a situation arises that is not addressed by these regulations, the Operations Division shall make determinations in accordance with generally accepted industry practices and standards.

Article 4. Personal Data Protection Policy

STEPIN Headquarters and the Operations Division shall securely manage all personal information of participants collected during the tournament registration and administration process — including in-game nicknames, user IDs, contact information, dates of birth, photographs and videos, and nationality — in accordance with STEPIN's Personal Data Protection Policy and ECA's data policies.

Collected information shall be used solely for purposes including tournament administration, participant identity verification, prize disbursement, and official communications, and shall not be disclosed to unrelated third parties without the prior consent of the participant.

Article 5. Definitions and Rules

5.1. Set

A Set refers to a single 1-on-1 dance battle conducted between two players. A Set constitutes the minimum unit of a Match, and the outcome of each Set determines the win or loss for that particular round.

5.2. Match

A Match refers to the competitive unit between players within the tournament. The player who wins the required number of Sets wins the Match and advances to the next stage.

5.3. Tournament Round

STEPIN tournaments shall be conducted in a Most Wins out of 7 Sets or Most Wins out of 9 Sets format (subject to adjustment to 3-Sets Most Wins or 5-Sets Most Wins as circumstances require). Results shall be announced after all Sets have been completed. Accordingly, players shall perform 7 to 9 dances consecutively without interruption.

In individual finals, if the Winner's Bracket player wins the Most Wins out of 9 Match, that player shall be immediately declared Champion. However, should the Loser's Bracket player defeat the Winner's Bracket player, an additional Most Wins out of 9 Match shall be held to determine the final Champion.

5.4. Tournament Format

The operational format shall be applied flexibly depending on the number of participants or teams as set forth below.

5.4.1. Individual Tournament Regulations

Individual tournaments shall combine a [Preliminary: Group Stage] and a [Main Bracket: Top 8 Double Elimination] format, adjusted according to the number of participants.

[Preliminary Round: Group Stage Rules]

- Basic Structure: Groups shall be divided and matches conducted in a full round-robin format, with top-ranked players in each group advancing to the main bracket.
- Match Operations: If exactly 8 players are participating, a Top 8 Double Elimination Tournament shall be held immediately without a Group Stage. If 9 to 16 players are participating, a Group Stage shall be held to select a total of 8 players based on the top performers from each group.
- 9–11 players: 2 groups / Top 4 from each group advance
- 12–16 players: 4 groups / Top 2 from each group advance

[Individual Main Bracket: Double Elimination Rules]

- Basic Structure: The bracket is divided into a Winner's Bracket and a Loser's Bracket. A player who accumulates two losses shall be eliminated from the tournament.
- Match Operations: All matches shall be performed consecutively without interruption as an endurance test.
- Regular Rounds: Most Wins out of 7 (7 Sets consecutively)

- Grand Finals: Most Wins out of 9 (9 Sets consecutively)
- Grand Final (Bracket Reset): If the Winner's Bracket finalist defeats the Loser's Bracket finalist, the tournament concludes at the "Final." If the Loser's Bracket finalist defeats the Winner's Bracket finalist, the bracket shall be reset to a 1:1 standing, and a Grand Final (9 Sets) shall be held to determine the ultimate champion.

5.4.2. Team Tournament Regulations

Team tournaments shall be conducted in either a Full Round Robin or Single Elimination format depending on the number of participating teams.

- 4–5 Teams: A single-group full round-robin shall be held, followed by placement matches (1st/2nd place Final and 3rd/4th place match).
- 6 Teams: A two-group Group Stage shall be held, with the top 2 teams from each group (4 teams total) advancing to a 4-team Single Elimination bracket. (Matchups: Group A 1st vs. Group B 2nd / Group B 1st vs. Group A 2nd)

[Team Match Format]

- Most Wins out of 7: Player A (3 Sets) + Player B (3 Sets) + Decider Player (final 1 Set), performed consecutively.
- Most Wins out of 9: Player A (4 Sets) + Player B (4 Sets) + Decider Player (final 1 Set), performed consecutively.

5.4.3. Group Stage Tiebreaker Rules

Group stage standings shall be determined first and foremost by the number of wins (points). In the event of a tie, the following criteria shall be applied in the order listed below.

In the Event of a Tie:

- Head-to-head result (winner of the direct matchup)
- Total Set differential
- Total point differential
- A single-set replay match, if advancement is at stake

Special Provisions:

- In the event of a forfeit or default loss, the result of that match shall be recorded as the minimum winning score for the opposing participant(s); no other statistical records shall be entered for that match.

5.5. Disconnection

5.5.1. Unintentional Disconnection

An unintentional disconnection refers to a situation in which a player's game connection is interrupted due to circumstances beyond the player's control, including platform errors, network failures, client or server malfunctions, or force majeure events. In the event of an unintentional disconnection, the referee and operations staff shall assess the circumstances and timing of the disconnection and render a final determination as to whether a rematch shall be conducted.

5.5.2. Intentional Disconnection

An intentional disconnection refers to a situation in which a player's game connection is interrupted as a result of deliberate action by the player. The Operations Division shall render its determination after comprehensively considering all relevant circumstances, including the player's intent and degree of fault. If a disconnection is ruled intentional, the relevant Set shall be immediately awarded as a forfeit loss to the disconnecting player. Depending on the severity of the offense, the Operations Division may impose additional disciplinary measures, including warnings and disqualification.

Chapter 3 — Organizing Committee

Article 6. ECA Operations Division

The ECA Operations Division shall have full authority and responsibility over all matters pertaining to the planning, rule-setting, and administration of the ECA STEPIN event main bracket and national qualification tournaments to be held in Jinju, Republic of Korea in April 2026.

Article 7. National Operations Divisions

Each National Operations Division shall, on behalf of its respective country, undertake all necessary activities relating to the selection, training, and tournament participation of players representing that country in the ECA STEPIN event.

Article 8. STEPIN Headquarters

STEPIN Headquarters shall hold full authority and responsibility over all software-related matters necessary for the conduct of this tournament, including the development, updates, system construction, and service operation of the iOS client, AOS client, STEPIN Arcade client, and servers.

Chapter 4 — Player Eligibility and Obligations

Article 9. Eligibility

9.1. Player Eligibility

9.1.1. Eligible Nationalities

Players competing in the Tournament must hold citizenship of one of the participating countries, including but not limited to the Republic of Korea, China, Japan, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam, and the Philippines.

9.1.2. Legal Standing

Any individual who has been convicted of a criminal offense or who is currently under criminal investigation pursuant to the laws of their respective country shall not be permitted to participate in the Tournament.

9.1.3. Minor Players

Minor players must obtain the prior written consent of a parent or legal guardian and shall

comply with the applicable minor protection laws of their respective country.

9.1.4. STEPIN Account Requirements

All players must hold a valid STEPIN service account and must not have any history of account sanctions imposed pursuant to the terms of service.

9.2. Identity Verification and National Operations Division Guarantee

9.2.1. The Korea e-Sports Association (KeSPA) shall bear primary responsibility for verifying the identity of all national representative players participating in this Tournament, validating player eligibility, and confirming the absence of any disqualifying conditions.

9.2.2. Each National Operations Division shall guarantee that the players selected to represent their respective country satisfy all legal and administrative requirements necessary for international competition participation, including valid visas and passports. Each National Operations Division shall further be obligated to confirm that selected players do not have any serious disqualifying circumstances that could cause public controversy or bring disrepute to the Tournament.

9.3. Prohibition on Transfer or Assignment of Tournament Participation Rights

The right and qualification of a player to participate in the Tournament shall not be transferred, assigned, conveyed, or sold to any other person. Notwithstanding the foregoing, in the event that a selected player becomes unable to participate due to unavoidable circumstances, the relevant National Operations Division may grant participation rights to a substitute player through a reasonable and fair process, provided that the Operations Division immediately notifies the ECA Operations Division of the grounds for such change, the selection process for the substitute, and the information of the newly designated participant.

Article 10. Player Obligations

10.1. Prior Review of Regulations

All players are obligated to thoroughly review this Rulebook and the specific regulations applicable to each tournament event prior to competing. Responsibility for any disadvantage arising from a failure to review the applicable regulations shall rest solely with the player.

10.2. Mutual Respect

All players shall treat fellow competitors, referees, operations staff, and fans with respect at all times. Disparaging remarks, abusive language, discriminatory conduct, and any other disrespectful behavior are strictly prohibited.

10.3. Sportsmanship

All players shall compete in each Match and Set with fairness and their utmost effort. All conduct contrary to the principles of sportsmanship is strictly prohibited, including match-fixing, intentional loss, and the exploitation of bugs.

10.4. Acceptance of Official Rulings

Players shall abide by all rulings issued by the Headquarters and the judging panel. Any formal objection to a ruling may only be raised in accordance with the procedures prescribed in these regulations.

10.5. Player Conduct and Reputation

Players shall conduct themselves with dignity befitting a member of the STEPIN community, both during the Tournament and in their daily lives. Players shall not engage in any illegal conduct or in any conduct that is socially reprehensible and that would damage the reputation of the Tournament or its participants.

10.6. Dress Code

10.6.1. Appropriateness of Attire

Players shall wear clean and appropriate attire suitable for dance performance throughout the Tournament. Attire bearing phrases, imagery, or designs that may cause offense to others or that could give rise to public controversy is strictly prohibited.

10.6.2. Dress Code for AI Scoring System

Scoring in this Tournament shall be conducted through an AI system that recognizes the movements and facial features of players. Accordingly, the following types of attire and accessories that may interfere with the accurate operation of the AI scoring system are strictly prohibited:

- Any item that partially or fully covers the face, including masks, hats, and sunglasses
- Excessively loose-fitting or unusually structured garments that may interfere with the AI's body-tracking capabilities

10.6.3. Authority of the Operations Division

If the Operations Division determines that a player's attire is in violation of the Tournament's dress code regulations, it may require the player to change attire, and the player shall comply with such a request. Failure to comply with a correction order shall result in the player being barred from participating in the main bracket.

Article 11. Rule Violations

Any conduct in violation of the provisions set forth in this Rulebook may result in the imposition of penalties following review by the Headquarters. Depending on the nature and severity of the violation, disciplinary measures may include verbal warnings, formal warnings, Set forfeits, Match forfeits, disqualification, prize money forfeiture, and suspension from future tournament participation.

Article 12. Discovery of Misconduct After Tournament Conclusion

Even after the conclusion of the Tournament, if a player's misconduct is discovered, the Headquarters may strip the player of all rankings and records and recover all prize money and prizes previously awarded. In addition, strong follow-up sanctions may be imposed on the relevant player, including permanent disqualification from future tournament participation.

Chapter 5 — Miscellaneous

Article 13. Tournament Copyright

All intellectual property rights in and to any content generated in connection with this Tournament — including broadcasts, online streams, images, videos, and Match and Set

records — shall vest in ECA and STEPIN Headquarters.

Article 14. Interpretation of Unspecified Matters

In the event that any matter arises that is not specified in this Rulebook, or in the event of a dispute regarding the interpretation of any provision herein, the final decision-making authority shall rest with the ECA Operations Division, and all relevant parties shall abide by that decision.